

The nuclear deal issue has been trivialised by equating Advani's Jinnah misadventure with his views on this subject and projecting that he has taken a stand against the party's official line. Since there has been no word from party president Rajnath Singh on the issue, it can be inferred that BJP is still to take an official stand on this.

SHANTI BHUSHAN, *Noida*

Don't Give it to Maya

Mayawati has always been a tough negotiator with every political party she has supported ("For a Few Rupees More", September 10). It is now up to the Congress to rise above petty political gains and not succumb to her unfair demands.

P.K. SRIVASTAVA, *on e-mail*

Pure Economics

It is an established fact that whenever mechanisation comes into force, there is a shift of labour from one area of operation to another ("Vote Bank Economics", September 10). This cannot be taken as a threat to the small traders and should be seen as a way of development.

VISWANATHAN S., *Chennai*

Celebrating Justice

Salman Khan's conviction proves that a celebrity status does not provide immunity from law ("The Buck Stops Here", September 10). And since they are constantly under scrutiny, celebrities earn respect and disrespect in equal terms.

MAN MOHAN BHATIA, *Delhi*

Game for Money

Who is illusory—the great Kapil Dev, who won the one and only World Cup for the country or the bunch of *babus* and their gully players, who bungle all the way and blink once in four years ("The Master of Illusion", September 10)?

N. DHARMESHWARAN, *Chennai*

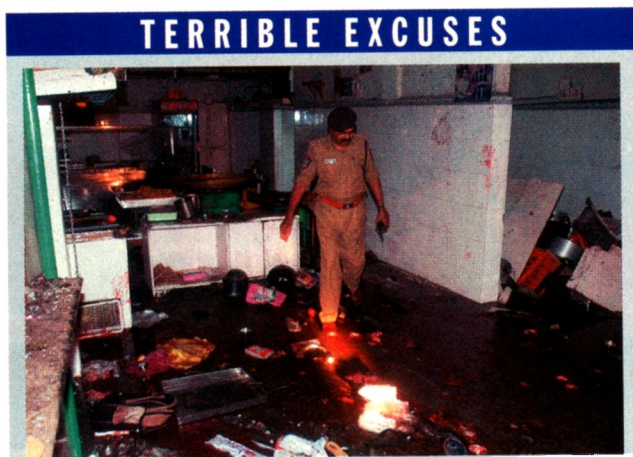
The country's disdain as reflected in the magazine notwithstanding, Dev has every right to earn some

money. Despite our individual performances, we, Indians have this tendency to fall back on our ancestral calling—trading. Traders are the best image managers, a job that Dev has done well.

J.B. SINGH, *on e-mail*

Dev's rhetoric that ICL will help "struggling players" is empty. ICL is a money-making venture and there is nothing wrong in admitting it.

A.V. KARNIK, *Mumbai*



TERRIBLE EXCUSES

It is high time we stopped talking about our "peace-loving ways" ("The Pak-Bangla Axis of Terror", September 10). Aren't these blasts reasons enough to attack countries like Pakistan and Bangladesh?

ARJYA PATNAIK, *Cuttack*

By taking a soft line towards terrorism, the UPA Government believes it is reaching out to the Muslims. What it does not realise is that such warped politics of appeasement recoils both on Hindus and Muslims.

A. VANI, *Hyderabad*

It has been argued that it is impossible for intelligence agencies to predict the time and place of a terror attack ("Change of Tactics", September 10). That may be true, but bombers are not born overnight. It's just that these agencies have to be more efficient.

V.K. SINGH, *Gurgaon*

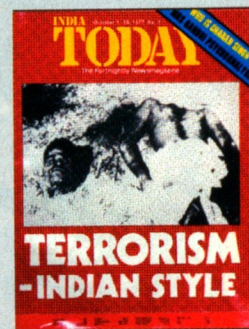
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Years Ago in India Today

OCTOBER 1-15, 1977



Saint or Sinner?

His opponents call him "Chair Singh". They charge him with being a cold, ruthless man with the sole ambition of sitting on the chair of the prime minister of India. They say he is probably the "original" defector (Aya Ram-Gaya Ram) in the country. To his admirers, Charan Singh

is the ultimate strongman, of impeccable integrity and total incorruptibility. No man, they say, has filled the office of the home minister so colossus-like since the days of Sardar Patel. The defector theory is hotly denied by them. Quoting his rigid convictions, they hold that such men have little choice but to leave a corrupted body. To himself, Singh is a man faced with a *Chakravayuh*. The capitalists, the communists, the elitist press and the so-called intelligentsia, are all stacked against him, he says.



—Ajay Singh

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